

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8
♥ A Q 3
♦ 10 9 6 3 2
♣ 9 7

♠ Q 6 5 3

♥ 7 4 2

♦ A K

♣ Q J 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 2

♥ K J 8 5

♦ J 8 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ A J 7 4

♥ 10 9 6

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 5

♠ 10 later.

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♥ 5. The defense wins 3 ♥ tricks, then switches to a ♦.

Losers: ♠ = ? ♥ = 3 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 ?

You have already lost the 3 ♥ tricks so you must pick up the trump suit without loss. The odds aren't in your favor, but you have no choice but to play East for the doubleton King.

East plays low.

A small ♠ from your hand, putting on the ♠ J when East plays low. When this holds the trick plunk down the ♠ A and hope.

This position is one that is misplayed very often.

Look what would have occurred if you had started with the ♠ Q. East would have covered with the ♠ K (if he had it) and you would have lost a trick to the

The only hope is to try to drop the ♠ K without wasting an extra honor.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ A Q
 ♦ 9 7 5 4
 ♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ K 10 5 4 3

♥ 6

♦ 8 3 2

♣ K 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ K J 9 8 7 4 2

♦ Q J

♣ A J 10

♠ Q J 9 7

♥ 10 5 3

♦ A K 10 6

♣ Q 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♥

Pass

1NT

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦ A

East is to play 4♥. South leads the ♦ A. The defenders take two ♦ tricks, then switch to a trump.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 4

The status is pretty clear, you've already lost the 2 ♦s so you have to keep your ♣ losers to just one. You have a good chance of pulling that off by playing for the ♣K and ♣Q to lie in different hands and taking two finesses.

But you will only be in dummy once more so you **MUST** make the first finesse right now.

North plays low.

A small ♣ from dummy to your ♣10. South wins with the ♣Q and plays another trump.

South leads the ♥5.

In dummy for the last time you must now take your second ♣ finesse.

North plays low.

A small ♣ to your ♣J. When the ♣J wins you pull any leftover trumps and your hand is good.

This Deal is an excellent example of how and when to use the Double-Finesse, which gives you a 75% chance of success.

It was probably a better example of watching your entries. If you had pulled another trump before taking that first ♣ finesse you would not have been able to take the second one.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ Q 4 3 2
♦ 5
♣ K Q 10 4 2

♠ 7 4 3

♥ J 6

♦ A J 10 7 2

♣ 8 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 2

♥ 10 9 8

♦ 4

♣ A J 9 5 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K Q 9 8 6 3

♣ —

West	North	East	South
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		Pass	1 ♦
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Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♥
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Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♦
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All Pass

6 ♦ by South

Lead: ♣K

South is to play 6 ♦. West leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=0 Total = 4

You don't really have 2 ♥ losers since both of them can be ruffed in dummy. The 2 ♠ losers are real, though, and must be dealt with. If East holds the ♠K then a simple finesse will win the contract for you. A 50% chance. But there is more to this Deal than a simple finesse, look at it carefully.

In addition to the trumps, dummy has another useful card, the ♥J. You can give yourself a second chance by playing West to hold the ♥Q.

You ruff the opening ♣ lead and pull trumps with the ♦K (they split 1-1).

A low ♥ toward the ♥J. West fidgets, then puts on the ♥Q and plays another ♣ which you ruff.

You are in control now. You play a ♥ to dummy's ♥J, then a ♠ back to your ♠A. Discard dummy's 2 ♠ losers on the ♥ A K and claim your slam.

Suppose that it was East who held the ♥Q. Your ♥J would have been taken and you wouldn't get the two ♠ discards.

Then you would have to rely on the ♠ finesse after all. You'd be no worse off because you could still discard one of dummy's ♠s on a big ♥.

This method of play gave you two chances instead of just one.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 5 3
 ♥ A J 8
 ♦ K Q
 ♣ A 10 7 2

♠ 10 9 8 2
 ♥ Q 6 3
 ♦ 9 5 3
 ♣ 8 4 3



♠ K J 7
 ♥ K 7
 ♦ A J 10 8
 ♣ K J 9 6

♠ 6 4
 ♥ 10 9 5 4 2
 ♦ 7 6 4 2
 ♣ Q 5

West	North	East	South
2NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	7NT	
All Pass			
7NT by West			
Lead: ♠ 10			

West is to play 7NT. North leads the ♠ 10.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=2 ♦=4 ♣=2 Total = 12

A. Conan Doyle would have called this "The Tale of Two Queens". You need to find one more trick and to do so you are going to have to find either the ♥Q or the ♣Q. You can finesse South for the ♥Q, and you can finesse either defender for the ♣Q.

So which will you choose?

Neither, yet. First take your 8 winners in ♠s and ♦s, hoping somebody discards something to help you. They don't.

The ♣A, then the ♣K, hoping the ♣Q falls. If she does you have your thirteenth trick in ♣s. If she doesn't you take the ♥K then finesse South for the ♥Q. Two chances.

As you see, the ♥ finesse would have failed. You might have guessed the ♣Q correctly, but you might not have.

It always pays to look for a second chance. Here you try to drop the ♣Q, and if it doesn't work you have the finesse for the ♥Q in reserve.

Why not try to drop the ♥Q and keep the finesse for the ♣Q in reserve? Because you and dummy had 8 ♣s between you and only 6 ♥s. So the ♣Q was far more likely to be doubleton than the ♥Q.